

Simtora Technologies, Inc.

Global People Supplement to the Human Resources Policy Manual

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Applies to	All employees, managers and HR staff of Simtora Technologies, Inc. and its subsidiaries in the United States, Pakistan, Germany, France, Australia and the United Kingdom, and everyone who manages, works with or relocates between those locations
Related manuals	HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001); Country HR Manuals: Pakistan (SIM-HR-101), Germany (SIM-HR-102), France (SIM-HR-103), Australia (SIM-HR-104), United Kingdom (SIM-HR-105); International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001); IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001); Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001); Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001); Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001); Facilities and Office Administration Manual (SIM-FAC-001); Company Overview (SIM-OVR-001)

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Introduction

Simtora started in San Francisco and now builds its products in five research and development (R&D) centers: **Lahore (Pakistan), Berlin (Germany), London (United Kingdom), Paris (France) and Sydney (Australia)**. The Human Resources Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001) was written for our U.S. employees and refers throughout to U.S. law: the Fair Labor Standards Act, the Family and Medical Leave Act, at-will employment, Form I-9, COBRA, 401(k) plans and so on. Those references do not apply in other countries.

This Supplement does three things:

1. It states **which parts of the HR Policy Manual apply everywhere** and which are U.S.-only (Part 1).
2. It sets **global standards** that every Simtora employee receives regardless of country, and rules for cross-border work, time zones, pay and mobility (Part 1).
3. It adds the **rules specific to the San Francisco headquarters and California** (Part 2) and points each non-U.S. employee to the **Country HR Manual** for their location (Part 3).

Our principles for working in many countries

1. **Local law is the floor.** No Simtora policy reduces a right that the law of the employee's country gives them.

2. **One company standard.** Respect, safety, fairness, anti-harassment, speaking up and no retaliation are the same everywhere.
3. **The more protective rule wins** on employment rights; **the stricter rule wins** on ethics, security and compliance.
4. **No second-class sites.** The same career frameworks, performance process, learning budget, recognition and access to leadership apply in every center.
5. **Fair across time zones.** Inconvenient meeting times are shared, not always borne by the same site.
6. **Plain language.** Where law requires, documents are provided in the local language.

How to use this Supplement

- If you are a **U.S. employee**, read SIM-HR-001 and Part 2 of this Supplement.
- If you work in **Pakistan, Germany, France, Australia or the United Kingdom**, read Part 1 of this Supplement and your **Country HR Manual**. Your Country HR Manual replaces the U.S.-only parts of SIM-HR-001 and tells you which other parts of SIM-HR-001 still apply to you.
- If you **manage people in another country**, read Part 1 and the Country HR Manual for each country your team members work in before you make decisions about hiring, hours, leave, discipline or termination. Talk to HR first.

Roles and responsibilities (summary)

Role	Main responsibilities under this Supplement
Employees	Follow the manual for their country; ask HR when a U.S.-based rule does not seem to fit; do not work from another country without approval.
Managers	Apply the correct country rules; consult HR before any hiring, discipline, change of terms or termination of a non-U.S. employee; share meeting-time burdens fairly.
Country leaders (Managing Director or Director of each center)	Act as statutory director of the local entity; sponsor the local HR partner; make sure local statutory obligations are met; host employee forums.
International HR Lead	

Part 1 – Global Framework

1.1 Purpose, Scope and Order of Precedence

Purpose. To make sure every employee is treated lawfully and consistently, whichever Simtora entity employs them.

Scope. All employees and, for the standards in 1.4, all contractors and agency workers while working for Simtora.

Order of precedence

When rules conflict, apply them in this order:

Order	Source	Comment
1	Mandatory law of the country (and state, province, region or city) where the employee habitually works	Includes statutes, regulations and binding collective or industry agreements.
2	The employee's written employment contract	If it is more favorable than the Company policy; terms less favorable than the law are void to that extent.
3	The Country HR Manual (or, in the U.S., SIM-HR-001 and Part 2 of this Supplement)	Sets standard local terms.
4	This Supplement (Part 1)	Global standards and cross-border rules.
5	The remaining parts of SIM-HR-001	Apply to non-U.S. employees only as Section 1.2 states.

Where a Company standard is more generous to the employee than the law (for example, the global parental leave standard), the Company standard applies in addition to the law, and Simtora may coordinate the two so that the employee does not receive the same benefit twice, as 1.5 and the Country HR Manuals state.

Status of this Supplement

This Supplement and the Country HR Manuals are guides to Simtora's policies. They are not contracts, except where a Country HR Manual says that a provision is incorporated into the employment contract because local law requires it. Simtora may amend them with notice and, where local law requires, after consulting employee representatives (see 1.11).

1.2 How the HR Policy Manual Applies Outside the United States

The table shows how each part of SIM-HR-001 applies to employees outside the U.S. "**Global**" means it applies as written. "**Adapted**" means the principle applies, but the Country HR Manual changes the details. "**U.S. only**" means it does not apply; the Country HR Manual gives the local equivalent.

SIM-HR-001 section	Status outside U.S.	Notes
1.1 Recruitment and Hiring	Adapted	Local right-to-work checks, background-check limits and language rules apply. Pay-range disclosure and no salary-history questions are global (1.7).
1.2 Classification and At-Will Employment	U.S. only	There is no at-will employment outside the U.S. Local contract and termination rules apply. FLSA classification does not apply; the local working-time rules do.
1.3 Onboarding	Adapted	Replace I-9, W-4 and U.S. benefits steps with local right-to-work, tax and social-insurance steps (Appendix C).
1.4 Introductory (Probation) Period	Adapted	Length and rules are set by the Country HR Manual.
1.5 Pay and Payroll	Adapted	Pay frequency, currency, deductions and overtime follow local law (1.7). The rule against deductions for Company property is global.
1.6 Expense Reimbursement	Adapted	Local currency, tax treatment and VAT/GST receipts (1.8 and SIM-GLB-001, Part 3).
1.7 Standards of Business Conduct	Global	Local anti-corruption laws also apply (SIM-GLB-001, Part 2). Gift limits are in USD equivalents.
1.8 Confidentiality, IP, Outside Activities	Adapted	Local rules on employee inventions, moral rights and restrictive covenants apply (1.13).
1.9 Acceptable Use, Monitoring, AI	Adapted	Monitoring is subject to local notice, works council and data-protection rules (1.12).
2.1 Performance Management		

1.3 Employing Entities, Employment Terms and Worker Categories

Employing entities

Each employee has one employer, the Simtora entity in the country where they work:

Country	Employer	Statutory leader
United States	Simtora Technologies, Inc.	CEO
Pakistan	Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited	Managing Director, Lahore
Germany	Simtora Technologies GmbH	Managing Director (Geschäftsführer), Berlin
France	Simtora Technologies SAS	Président, Paris
Australia	Simtora Technologies Pty Ltd	Director, Sydney
United Kingdom	Simtora Technologies UK Limited	Director, London

A person who works in a country without a Simtora entity may be employed only through an approved employer-of-record arrangement, approved in advance by the Chief People Officer, General Counsel and CFO (1.9).

Employment terms

- Every employee receives a **written employment contract or offer** that complies with local law before or on the first day of work. It states the employer, role, place of work, pay, hours, leave, notice, probation and applicable collective agreement where relevant. The Country HR Manual lists required items.
- Only HR may sign or change employment terms. Managers must not make promises about pay, title, equity, leave or job security.
- At-will language in SIM-HR-001 is **not used** outside the U.S.

Worker categories

Category	Applies outside U.S.?	Notes
Regular full-time and part-time	Yes	Same definitions as SIM-HR-001 1.2, with local thresholds for benefits.
Fixed-term	Yes, within local limits	Several countries restrict fixed-term contracts (for example, Germany and France). HR approves each one.
Interns and students	Yes	Local rules on pay, duration and supervision apply.
Contractors and consultants	Yes, with a classification review	Misclassification carries serious risk everywhere (for example, UK off-payroll rules, Australian sham-contracting law, German and French false self-employment). HR and Legal review before work starts; Procurement Policy Manual 6.3 applies.
Agency workers	Yes	Via approved agencies only; local equal-treatment rules may apply.

1.4 Global People Standards

These standards apply to every Simtora employee, contractor and agency worker, in every country. They are a minimum: local law and Country HR Manuals may give more.

#	Standard	What it means
1	Equal opportunity	No discrimination in hiring, pay, promotion, discipline or termination on any ground that is protected where the employee works, or on race, color, ethnicity, nationality, religion or belief, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, age, disability, pregnancy, family or caring status, or any other ground protected by local law.
2	Respect and anti-harassment	Harassment, bullying, sexual harassment and intimidation are prohibited. Complaints are acknowledged within 2 business days and investigated promptly and fairly, following local procedure.
3	Speaking up	Anyone can report a concern to a manager, HR, ethics@simtora.example (anonymous reports accepted) or audit@simtora.example . Reports are acknowledged within 5 business days (or sooner where local law requires, for example 7 calendar days under German law).
4	No retaliation	Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith, takes protected leave, or takes part in an investigation is prohibited.
5	Fair pay, on time	Pay is at least the local legal minimum, paid on the scheduled day, with lawful deductions only. No deductions from pay for loss or damage to Company property (SIM-HR-001 1.5), except where local law requires or permits them and the employee has agreed separately in writing.
6	Safe workplace	A safe office and safe remote working conditions; same-day injury reporting; no work under unsafe conditions.
7	Reasonable hours and rest	Statutory working-time limits and rest periods are respected; no one is penalized for taking legal rest or leave.
8	Right to disconnect	No expectation to answer work messages outside working hours unless on call or in a declared incident.

1.5 Global Parental Leave Standard

Parental leave laws differ greatly. Simtora therefore sets one outcome for everybody and uses statutory pay as part of funding it.

Element	Standard
Primary caregiver	Up to 12 weeks at 100% of regular pay for birth, adoption, surrogacy or foster placement
Secondary caregiver	Up to 6 weeks at 100% of regular pay
Eligibility	6 months of service at the date of birth or placement for the Simtora-funded portion. Statutory leave and pay rights apply from the date the law gives them, with no service requirement beyond the law's.
Who	All genders and family types. If both parents work for Simtora, each takes leave in their own category.
Relationship to statute	Statutory leave and pay are taken first and count toward the 12 or 6 weeks. Simtora tops up statutory pay so total income during the Simtora-paid window equals 100% of regular pay (net-equivalent where the law pays statutory benefits tax-free). Statutory leave that is longer than 12 or 6 weeks remains available on the statutory terms (usually at the statutory rate, or unpaid).
Timing	Within 12 months of birth or placement, in one block or two, or as local law requires.
Job protection	The same or an equivalent job on return, as local law requires and at least as in SIM-HR-001 6.5.
Return-to-work support	Flexible ramp-up, lactation time and a private space, and access to the Employee Assistance Program.
Repayment	No repayment of Simtora-funded leave pay if the employee does not return, except where the individual agreement and local law allow.

Each Country HR Manual shows exactly how the top-up works there. Example: in Germany, the statutory maternity period is 14 weeks and employer top-up brings pay to 100% of net for the first 12 weeks, and in Australia government Paid Parental Leave is claimed alongside Simtora's top-up.

1.6 Working Across Time Zones, On-Call and Follow-the-Sun

Purpose. To make cross-border work sustainable and fair.

Core hours and shared windows

- **Core hours** remain 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in each employee's own local time (SIM-HR-001 5.1).
- Teams with members in several countries agree **one or two shared collaboration windows**, record them in the team charter and review them every six months.

Typical shared windows (approximate; they shift with daylight saving time, so always use calendar tools that show each person's local time):

Pair of sites	Practical shared window	Notes
San Francisco and London	8:00–10:00 a.m. Pacific = 4:00–6:00 p.m. London	Normal
San Francisco and Berlin / Paris	8:00–9:30 a.m. Pacific = 5:00–6:30 p.m. local	Ends before European evening; Berlin and Paris have a legal daily rest rule
San Francisco and Lahore	7:00–8:00 a.m. Pacific = 8:00–9:00 p.m. Lahore	Limited; mostly asynchronous; rotate the burden
San Francisco and Sydney	3:00–4:30 p.m. Pacific = next morning in Sydney	Works well for handoffs
London / Berlin / Paris and Lahore	9:00 a.m.–12:00 noon in Europe = about 1:00–5:00 p.m. Lahore	Good overlap
Lahore and Sydney	9:00 a.m.–12:00 noon in Lahore = about 2:00–6:00 p.m. Sydney	Good overlap
Europe and Sydney	8:00–9:00 a.m. in Europe = evening in Sydney	Use sparingly

Meeting fairness

- No employee is required to attend **more than two meetings a week outside 8:00 a.m.–7:00 p.m. local time**, and none before 7:00 a.m. or after 9:00 p.m. local time, except in a declared incident.
- When a recurring meeting must fall outside someone's usual day, the team **rotates** the inconvenient slot at least quarterly.
- People who attend outside their hours may start later or finish earlier the same or next day, or take equivalent time in lieu, with their manager. Where local law has stricter rest rules (11 hours' rest in the EU, UK and Pakistan's weekly rest, for example), law prevails.
- Record meetings and write decisions down so that anyone who cannot attend can contribute asynchronously.

- Keep core-hours and "do not disturb" settings current. Do not schedule over another person's declared hours.

On-call and follow-the-sun

- Production on-call, Support and Security rotations are organized **follow-the-sun** where team location allows: San Francisco, then Sydney, then Lahore, then London/Berlin/Paris. Regular on-call shifts should fall within **7:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m. local time**.
- **Overnight on-call** is only as a backup for Severity 1 events, on a volunteer or rotating basis, and never for more than **one week in four** (SIM-HR-001 5.3).
- **Handoffs** use a written note in the incident or ticket system that states open issues, owners, risks and next steps. An engineer must not leave an active SEV 1 without handoff.
- **Pay.** On-call stipend and call-out pay follow SIM-HR-001 5.3, expressed in local currency and at least as high as local law requires. The Country HR Manuals show how on-call time counts as working time, rest, and compensation in each country.
- **Rest after incidents.** At least **11 hours** of rest between finishing an out-of-hours incident and resuming normal work (more where the law requires). Managers adjust schedules; no one needs to ask permission to take it.
- **Right to refuse.** Employees can ask to leave a rotation for health or caring reasons; HR considers accommodations under local law.

1.7 Pay, Currency, Payroll and Equity

Currency, pay frequency and local payroll

Item	Standard
Currency	Employees are paid in the currency of their country (USD, PKR, EUR, AUD, GBP) into a bank account in that country.
Pay frequency	Local law and practice: bi-weekly (U.S.), fortnightly (Australia), monthly (Pakistan, Germany, France, United Kingdom), as in the Country HR Manuals.

Salary setting

- Pay is set from **local market data for the role, level and country**, using the Company's career frameworks, not from the employee's personal circumstances. Salary bands are held in the local currency and reviewed every year in the Company merit cycle.
- Moving within the same country does not change pay because of the move alone. Moving to another country changes pay to that country's band, with a transition rule in 1.10.
- Simtora runs its annual **pay-equity analysis** across all countries and corrects unjustified gaps (SIM-HR-001 1.5, SIM-FIN-001 reserve of at least 0.25% of base payroll).
- **Pay transparency.** Every job posting and offer discussion in every country states the pay range for the role, and Simtora does not ask candidates about their pay history. This is a global standard that also meets the EU Pay Transparency Directive (2023/970) as member states implement it, and California and other U.S. state laws.
- Employees may discuss their pay, and Simtora does not penalize them for doing so.

Bonuses and equity

- The annual performance bonus plan and the Equity Incentive Plan apply to eligible roles in every country. Awards in each country are made only after Legal and Tax confirm the **local securities, tax and exchange-control treatment** (for example, local sub-plans, filings and employer-social-contribution rules). Tax-advantaged local schemes (such as an approved UK option scheme or a French free-share plan) are used only if Legal and Tax confirm eligibility.
- The plan document and award agreement govern vesting and separation. Local mandatory law (for example, on payment during notice or notice periods and bonus entitlements) prevails over any contrary plan wording.
- Sales commission plans are written in local law-compliant form, including commission payment timing and calculation on termination where local law requires.

1.8 Allowances, Expenses and Business Travel Outside the United States

Allowances

Allowance	Global standard	Local rule
Home-office allowance	US \$500 <i>one – time</i> ; <i>upto</i> US \$1,000 for fully remote employees	Paid in local currency at the Company's published monthly rate. Local law may require more (for example, necessary costs in California; employer contribution to home working costs in France).
Connectivity stipend	US \$75 per month for employees who work from home at least one day a week	Local tax rules decide whether it is taxable. Where local law or tax rules require reimbursement of actual costs, that applies.
Learning budget	US \$1,500 per year and 40 hours of paid learning time	Local currency. Some places also provide statutory training leave (for example, Berlin's Bildungszeit, French training rights). These are additional.
Wellness stipend	As the Benefits Guide states	Local currency; local tax treatment.

Expense reimbursement

- SIM-HR-001 1.6 applies globally, with **local currency** receipts and **local invoice and VAT/GST rules**. Claims are made within 30 days and paid within 10 business days, using the exchange rate in SIM-FIN-001 2.5 and SIM-GLB-001 Part 3.
- Receipts are required over the equivalent of *25 itemized receipts for single meal over the equivalent of 50*.
- Where tax rules require a special format (for example, a French or German VAT invoice, an Australian tax invoice for GST credits), the employee obtains it from the supplier.

Business travel

- SIM-HR-001 8.1 applies to travel by non-U.S. employees, with these changes:

- **Per diem and lodging for destinations in the U.S.** follow GSA rates; for destinations outside the U.S. follow the U.S. State Department foreign per diem rates, as in SIM-HR-001 8.1.
 - **Travel time** is working time as local law provides (for example, in Germany and France, travel during working hours; in Australia, travel direction by the employer).
 - **Visas, vaccinations, travel insurance and assistance** are arranged through the travel platform. Employees must hold the right to enter and work in the destination country. A business visitor may not do work that requires a work permit.
 - **Sanctioned and high-risk destinations.** Travel to a country subject to comprehensive U.S., UK, EU or UN sanctions is prohibited. Travel to high-risk destinations needs Security approval (SIM-GLB-001, Part 5).
 - Trips into or out of Pakistan are approved against current official travel advice for the traveler's nationality, and traveler tracking is mandatory.
 - **Team gatherings.** Each R&D center sends representatives to an annual all-hands in San Francisco, and U.S. teams visit the centers at least once a year. Travel is paid by the Company.
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1.9 Remote Work, Work from Abroad and Cross-Border Arrangements

Purpose. Working in a different country than the one that employs you can create tax, immigration, social security, employment-law, permanent-establishment, export-control and security consequences for the employee and Simtora.

Standard

Situation	Rule
Hybrid work in your own country	Allowed (Tuesday to Thursday anchor days; at least 3 office days). Fully remote roles are approved by the Department Head and HR and must be within the country of employment (SIM-HR-001 5.2).
Work from another country, short term	Up to 20 working days in a calendar year may be approved, for personal reasons (for example, visiting family), if the employee has the right to be there and to work remotely, holds no role needing a local permit, does not conduct sales or contracting activity, and handles no Restricted data from unsecured networks. Request at least 30 days ahead (Appendix B). Approval by manager and HR; Finance (Tax) and IT Security informed.
Work from another country, longer term or permanent	Treated as a relocation or new hire: needs approval from the Department Head, HR, Legal, Tax and IT Security, and typically a new local employer or an approved employer-of-record. The employee cannot start work until approved.
Sanctioned or embargoed countries	Never allowed.
Digital nomad / rolling location	Not allowed.
EU/UK holidays and working time	Remote work from a holiday location does not replace annual leave.

Working from abroad without approval is a breach of policy and may lead to corrective action under local procedure, and the employee may bear responsibility for taxes or penalties that arise from their own unreported situation.

Security and data

- Use only Company devices with VPN and MFA (SIM-IT-001 4.6).
- Customer production data and Restricted data are not accessed from outside the countries listed in the employee's approved access profile (SIM-GLB-001, Part 1).

- Export-controlled technology and source code may not be taken to or accessed from a destination the General Counsel has not cleared (SIM-GLB-001, Part 2).

1.10 Global Mobility: Transfers, Secondments, Relocation and Visas

Types of mobility

Type	Duration	Employer	Notes
Business visit	Up to 30 days	Home entity	No productive local work that needs a permit.
Short-term assignment	31 days–6 months	Home entity	Needs immigration, tax and social security advice; written assignment letter.
Secondment	6–24 months	Home entity, work at host site	Secondment agreement; tax and social security certificates (for example, A1 certificates within the EU, totalization or social security agreements).
Permanent transfer	Indefinite	New local entity (home contract ends or is suspended)	New local contract; continuity of service recognized for Company benefits where law allows; local rules apply from the transfer date.
Remote relocation	Employee's own wish	New local entity or none	Not available without approval (1.9). Not funded unless approved.

Process

1. **Request.** Manager and Department Head with HR (at least **90 days** before the intended start for transfers and secondments).

2. **Review.** HR, Legal, Tax and Payroll confirm right-to-work and visa options, tax and social security, benefits, pay level, family needs and cost. Approval by the Department Head, Chief People Officer and CFO (Appendix A).
3. **Agreement.** Written assignment or transfer letter signed before departure.
4. **Support.** Relocation allowance and temporary housing under SIM-HR-001 7.6, adapted to the destination: up to 60 days' temporary housing, a lump sum or estimate for shipment, a visa and immigration service, tax-return support in the home and host country for the assignment years, and a language class where useful.
5. **Return.** Return rights are in the assignment letter. Repayment of relocation costs within 12 months of a voluntary leaving applies only where local law allows.

Visas and right to work

- Simtora sponsors work visas only for roles approved in advance. Immigration filings are made through Legal and approved immigration counsel.
- Employees must not begin work until the right to work has been confirmed by HR. Employees must tell HR at least **90 days** before a visa or permit expires. Simtora does not recover visa costs from an employee who leaves, except where the individual agreement and local law permit a pro-rated repayment for a voluntary departure within 12 months of an optional, employee-requested service.

Pay on mobility

- A transfer moves the employee to the host country's pay band. For up to 12 months afterward, HR may agree to a **transition payment** so that net purchasing power is not materially reduced. Any secondees' pay is described in the assignment letter.

1.11 Employee Representation and Consultation

Some countries give employees collective rights. Simtora respects them.

Country	Typical bodies	What Simtora does
United States	Employees have the right under federal law (National Labor Relations Act) to discuss pay and working conditions and to act together	No interference or retaliation.
Pakistan	Collective bargaining agents and works councils may exist under provincial and federal law where thresholds are met	Complies with applicable industrial relations law (SIM-HR-101).
Germany	Works council (<i>Betriebsrat</i>) may be elected in any workplace with 5 or more permanent employees; co-determination rights	Supports an election if employees choose to hold one; consults the council on matters it has rights over, including monitoring technology and working time (SIM-HR-102).
France	Social and Economic Committee (<i>Comité social et économique</i> , CSE), mandatory at 11 or more employees; trade union delegates	Holds CSE elections as the law requires and consults the CSE (SIM-HR-103).
Australia	Employees may be represented by unions; enterprise bargaining is possible	Respects the right to representation, workplace delegates and consultation duties (SIM-HR-104).
United Kingdom	Trade union recognition is possible; information and consultation arrangements; collective redundancy consultation	Complies with the right to be accompanied and with consultation rules (SIM-HR-105).

Rules for managers:

- Do not discourage, question or take any action against anyone for joining, forming or taking part in a representative body, or for raising a concern with it.

- Before you change working hours, monitoring tools, remote-work rules, performance-measurement methods or the way you assess employees in Germany or France, speak to HR. A consultation or agreement may be required first. A change without the required step may be void.
 - **Country forums.** Each center holds at least two employee forums a year with the country leader and the local HR partner, and the Chief People Officer visits each center at least once a year. Notes and actions are published to the center.
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1.12 Employee Privacy, Monitoring and Records

Purpose. To protect employees' personal data and set the limits on monitoring.

Principles (global)

- Personal data about employees and candidates is collected only for specific, lawful, stated purposes, is kept accurate and secure, and is retained only as long as necessary.
- Employees get a **privacy notice** that says what is collected, why, who sees it, where it goes (including transfers to the U.S.), how long it is kept and how to exercise rights. In the EU and the UK, the Company relies on a lawful basis (usually the employment contract, legal obligation or legitimate interests), not employee consent.
- **Monitoring** under SIM-HR-001 1.9 and SIM-IT-001 is necessary, proportionate and transparent. It targets security and system integrity, not employees' private lives. Covert or continuous monitoring of individuals is prohibited without Legal and HR approval and a documented reason (for example, a serious investigation), and where local law permits.

Local rules in short

Country	Key points (details in the Country HR Manual)
United States (California)	CCPA/CPRA applies to employee and applicant data: notice at collection, rights to know, delete and correct, no sale or sharing. Written monitoring notice.
Pakistan	No comprehensive data-protection statute yet in force at the effective date; the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act and constitutional privacy apply. Simtora applies the Company standard.
Germany	GDPR and the Federal Data Protection Act (BDSG); works council co-determination on monitoring technology; limited private use of IT rules.
France	GDPR; CNIL guidance; CSE consultation and prior individual notice before monitoring; personal-use protections for messages marked personal.
Australia	Privacy Act and the NSW Workplace Surveillance Act: written notice at least 14 days before computer surveillance begins; the Australian employee-records exemption does not remove Simtora's global commitments.
United Kingdom	UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018; data protection impact assessment for monitoring; transparency.

Data subject requests and transfers

- Requests from employees and candidates to access, correct, delete or restrict their data are sent to `privacy@simtora.example`. The Privacy Lead acknowledges within 10 business days and responds within **one month** where GDPR or UK GDPR applies (extendable by law) and otherwise within 45 days (SIM-CMP-001 4.1).
- Employee data moves between Simtora entities under the intra-group data-transfer agreement (EU standard contractual clauses and the UK addendum) and, where available, the EU–U.S. Data Privacy Framework (SIM-GLB-001, Part 2).
- HR systems hold employee data in access-restricted regions. Only people who need data for their role can see it.

Records and retention

- HR keeps personnel, payroll and leave records for the period local law requires and no longer than needed. The Country HR Manuals list the periods. Where law sets no period, the Compliance retention schedule (SIM-CMP-001 4.4) applies. Recruitment records of unsuccessful candidates are kept for the period local law allows (in the EU and UK, usually 6 months to 12 months with notice) and 3 years in the U.S.
 - Legal holds (SIM-CMP-001 4.4) override deletion.
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1.13 Intellectual Property, Confidentiality and Restrictive Covenants

Principle. All intellectual property created by employees in the course of their work belongs to Simtora Technologies, Inc. (SIM-HR-001 1.8). The legal route to that result differs by country.

Country	Key points
United States	Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement; California Labor Code 2870 limits assignment of inventions made entirely on the employee's own time without Company resources.
Pakistan	Employer owns works created under a contract of service; written assignment and moral-rights waivers where permitted; confidentiality clauses are enforceable during and after employment if reasonable.
Germany	Software created in employment passes to the employer by law (Copyright Act, §69b). Patentable employee inventions follow the Employee Inventions Act : Simtora claims the invention within 4 months of notification and pays a statutory inventor's remuneration .
France	Software created in the course of employment belongs to the employer by law; "mission inventions" belong to the employer but the employee has a right to additional remuneration under the contract or collective agreement. Non-compete clauses require compensation.
Australia	Employer generally owns IP created in employment; written assignment and moral-rights consents are included in the contract.
United Kingdom	Employer owns copyright and patentable inventions made in the course of duties; employees may claim compensation for inventions of outstanding benefit; written assignment for the rest.

Restrictive covenants. Non-compete, non-solicitation and similar clauses are used sparingly and only in a form that is enforceable where the employee works:

- **California and several other U.S. states:** non-competes are void; Simtora does not use them (SIM-HR-001 9.4).
- **Germany and France:** a post-employment non-compete requires a written agreement, a legitimate interest, a limited scope and duration and **financial compensation**.
- **United Kingdom, Australia and Pakistan:** limited to what protects legitimate business interests and reasonable in scope, duration and area. Non-competes are used for senior or sensitive roles only, approved by Legal.
- **Protected rights.** No confidentiality term restricts an employee from reporting wrongdoing to authorities, using whistleblower channels, discussing pay and

conditions, or taking part in a legal or regulatory process. Agreements say so (SIM-HR-001 1.8).

Employees complete the local form of the Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement before or on the first day.

1.14 Language, Documents and Acknowledgements

- The working language of the Company is **English**.
 - Where local law requires, the **employment contract, working-time rules, safety instructions, disciplinary rules and any document that creates obligations for the employee** are provided in the local language (this is mandatory in France under the Toubon Law and may be required in other places). The local-language version governs for the employee where the law says so.
 - HR publishes translations of the Country HR Manual (French for France; German for Germany; Urdu summaries for Pakistan on request).
 - At onboarding, every employee signs the local acknowledgement (Appendix A of the Country HR Manual) and, in the U.S., Appendix A of SIM-HR-001. Digital acknowledgement through the HR system is valid.
 - Required statutory information (for example, the Fair Work Information Statement in Australia, the written statement of particulars in the United Kingdom) is provided on or before the start date.
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1.15 HR Governance and Local Support

Item	Standard
International HR Lead	Reports to the Chief People Officer; owns this Supplement day to day; contact <code>hr-intl@simtora.example</code> .
Local HR partners	One per center, or shared where a center has fewer than 20 employees; each center has a named person employees can reach in their own time zone.
Local counsel	The General Counsel retains employment counsel in each country and in California; HR must consult counsel before any termination, restructuring, change of terms, restrictive covenant, works council or CSE matter, or government inspection.
Policy review	Each Country HR Manual is reviewed every January and whenever the law changes. HR monitors law changes through counsel and publishes updates within 30 days of a change taking effect.
Metrics	Quarterly reporting to the Executive Team and the International Review: headcount, turnover, time to hire, pay-equity results, employee-relations cases, statutory deadlines met, training completion.
Audit	Annual audit of payroll and statutory compliance in each country, reported to the Audit Committee (SIM-FIN-001 9.5).

Part 2 – United States: San Francisco Headquarters and California

2.1 Scope and Principle

Simtora's headquarters is in **San Francisco, California**, and many U.S. employees work in California. California and San Francisco law is, in many respects, the strictest in the United States. SIM-HR-001 already refers to California in several places. This Part collects the **main California and San Francisco rules** that managers and HR must apply to employees who

work in California. **Where California or San Francisco law gives more than SIM-HR-001, the law applies.** For employees in other states, see 2.5.

2.2 California Employment Rules

Topic	Rule at Simtora
Wages and overtime	Non-exempt employees receive overtime at 1.5x for hours over 8 in a workday or 40 in a workweek, and for the first 8 hours on the 7th consecutive day; 2x for hours over 12 in a day and for hours over 8 on the 7th consecutive day.
Exempt status	Exempt professional, administrative and computer-professional roles must meet the California duties and salary tests, including a salary of at least twice the state minimum wage for full-time work. HR reviews classifications annually.
Meal and rest breaks	Non-exempt employees: a 30-minute meal period before the end of the 5th hour of work (waivable by mutual consent if the shift is 6 hours or less), a second meal period for shifts over 10 hours, and a paid 10-minute rest break for each 4 hours (or major fraction). If a break is missed, the employee receives one additional hour of pay per type of missed break per day.
Pay frequency and statements	Pay at least as often as California law requires; itemized wage statements with the required information.
Final pay	Termination: all wages, including earned vacation (PTO), immediately on the last day. Resignation: on the last day if the employee gave 72 hours' notice; within 72 hours if not. Late payment triggers waiting-time penalties.
PTO	PTO is earned wages: no use-it-or-lose-it forfeiture . Simtora applies an accrual cap of 1.5 times the annual accrual (SIM-HR-001 6.2). All accrued PTO is paid at separation.
Paid sick leave	At least the state's minimum; Simtora's 8 days (64 hours) exceeds it. San Francisco employees may accumulate at least 72 hours . Sick leave can be used for the employee or a "designated person" and for victims of domestic violence, sexual assault and stalking.
Expense reimbursement	Labor Code 2802: Simtora reimburses all necessary business expenses, including a reasonable share of personal phone and

2.3 San Francisco Ordinances

Employees who work in the City and County of San Francisco have additional rights. Legal and HR maintain the details; the main ones are:

Ordinance	What it means at Simtora
Paid Sick Leave Ordinance	Accrual of 1 hour for every 30 hours worked, with an accumulation cap of at least 72 hours (employers with 10 or more employees). Simtora's front-loaded 8 days (64 hours) is supplemented to reach 72 hours accumulated for San Francisco employees.
Paid Parental Leave Ordinance	Employers must supplement state Paid Family Leave so that eligible employees receive 100% of their normal pay (up to the ordinance's cap) during 6 weeks of bonding leave. Simtora's 12-week and 6-week programs satisfy this and exceed it.
Family Friendly Workplace Ordinance	Eligible employees (6 months' service, 8+ hours per week, who are caregivers) may request a flexible or predictable work schedule; Simtora responds in writing within 21 days and cannot retaliate.
Health Care Security Ordinance	Simtora's medical plans meet the required health care expenditure.
Fair Chance Ordinance	Applies alongside the state Fair Chance Act.
Commuter Benefits	Simtora offers the required pre-tax commuter benefit (SIM-HR-001 6.9) and complies with the regional (Bay Area) program.
Minimum wage	San Francisco's minimum wage applies to non-exempt employees working in the city.
Salary history and pay equity	No questions about prior pay.

2.4 Reporting, Training and Postings

- HR keeps the **required California and San Francisco postings** in every office and on the HR intranet for remote workers.
- HR files the California pay data report, EEO-1 federal report and Cal-OSHA logs on time.
- California harassment prevention training, workplace violence training and IIPP training are delivered and recorded by HR and Facilities.
- Tax registrations (San Francisco payroll expense, gross receipts and business registration) are maintained by Tax (SIM-FIN-001 10.1 and 10.4).

2.5 Employees in Other U.S. States

Employees outside California are covered by SIM-HR-001 and the law of the state and city where they work. Examples of laws that may be more generous than SIM-HR-001 include state paid family leave (New York, New Jersey, Washington, Massachusetts, Colorado and others), paid sick leave laws in many cities and states, state final-pay and PTO payout rules, state minimum-wage and overtime rules, and state monitoring-notice laws. HR checks state law at hire (and when an employee moves) and records the result. Finance and Tax are told **30 days before** a first hire in a new state (SIM-FIN-001 10.1).

Part 3 – Country Manuals and Comparison

3.1 Where to Find Your Manual

Location	Employing entity	Manual	Document ID
San Francisco / United States	Simtora Technologies, Inc.	HR Policy Manual + this Supplement, Part 2	SIM-HR-001
Lahore, Pakistan	Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited	Pakistan HR Manual	SIM-HR-101
Berlin, Germany	Simtora Technologies GmbH	Germany HR Manual	SIM-HR-102
Paris, France	Simtora Technologies SAS	France HR Manual	SIM-HR-103
Sydney, Australia	Simtora Technologies Pty Ltd	Australia HR Manual	SIM-HR-104
London, United Kingdom	Simtora Technologies UK Limited	United Kingdom HR Manual	SIM-HR-105

Each Country HR Manual uses the same structure (Parts 1–10) so that managers who work across countries can compare them: (1) employer, legal framework and scope; (2) hiring, contracts and probation; (3) working time, remote work and on-call; (4) pay, payroll, tax and social contributions; (5) leave and holidays; (6) benefits and retirement; (7) equality, respect, employee voice and speaking up; (8) safety, privacy and intellectual property; (9) performance, discipline and separation; (10) local practices; then appendices (key terms and acknowledgement, holiday rules, statutory deadlines, revision history).

3.2 Key Entitlements Compared

This table is a summary only. The Country HR Manual and the law govern. Figures are for full-time employees after any qualifying period.

Item	United States	Pakistan	Germany	France	Australia	United Kingdom
Standard week	40 h (Mon–Fri)	40 h (legal max 48 h)	40 h (8 h/day; avg. max 8 h, 10 h peak)	35 h legal; 38.5 h with extra days off, or annual day-count for eligible autonomous cadres	38 h	40 h (48 h average cap, opt-out in writing)
Probation	90 days (+30)	3 months (+3)	6 months	4 months for cadres (3 for technicians), renewable once where allowed	6 months	3 months (up to 6)
Annual leave	PTO 15 / 20 / 25 days	20 days annual + 10 days casual	30 days	25 working days + RTT days where applicable	25 days (20 statutory + 5)	25 days, rising to 28 after 5 years
Public holidays	11 + 2 floating	About 14–16 as notified	10 (Berlin) + Dec 24 and Dec 31	10 paid (Whit Monday is the solidarity day)	Up to 11 (NSW)	8 (England and Wales)

			benefit	Statutory benefits + Simtora top-up to 100% net for up to 60 days	10 days personal/care leave (statutory)
Parental leave (Simtora-funded)	12 weeks / 6 weeks at 100%	12 weeks / 6 weeks at 100%	12 weeks / 6 weeks at 100% net with statutory top-up	12 weeks / 6 weeks at 100% with statutory top-up	12 weeks / 6 weeks at 100% with government PPL
Statutory parental leave	FMLA / CFRA (unpaid) + state PFL	12 weeks maternity pay	14 weeks Mutterschutz; up to 3 years Elternzeit	16+ weeks; 25 days partner leave	Up to 12 months unpaid (+12) and government PPL
Notice (employee)	Requested 2 weeks	1 month	3 months to month-end after probation (statutory 4 weeks)	Per collective agreement (1 to 3 months)	4 weeks after probation (statutory scale)
Notice (employer)	None (at will)	1 month	3 months to month-end or the longer statutory period	Per collective agreement; legal procedure required	Statutory scale (1–5 weeks) or longer contractual term
Dismissal					

protection	At will	Standing orders and inquiry	Dismissal protection law after 6 months; works council hearing	Real and serious cause; procedure	Fair Work Act unfair dismissal after 6 months
Employee body	None required	Possible	Works council	CSE required (11+ employees)	Union delegate
Pay cycle	Bi-weekly	Monthly	Monthly	Monthly	Fortnightly
Retirement	401(k)	Provident Fund + statutory EOBI	Statutory pension + employer pension	Statutory + complementary schemes	Superannuation 12%

3.3 Public Holidays by Location

HR publishes each country's holiday calendar by **December 1** for the next year. Local lists are in each Country HR Manual.

Location	Typical holidays	Notes
United States	11 + 2 floating (SIM-HR-001 6.1)	Winter shutdown December 26–31 using PTO or Company days.
Pakistan	Kashmir Solidarity Day, Pakistan Day, Labour Day, Eid ul Fitr (3 days), Eid ul Adha (3 days), Youm-e-Takbeer, Independence Day, Ashura (2 days), Eid Milad un Nabi, Iqbal Day, Quaid-e-Azam Day (Dec 25)	Dates of Islamic holidays depend on the moon-sighting and are announced by the government; HR adjusts the calendar quickly.
Germany (Berlin)	New Year's Day, International Women's Day, Good Friday, Easter Monday, Labour Day, Ascension Day, Whit Monday, German Unity Day, Christmas Day, Boxing Day	Plus company days off on December 24 and December 31.
France	New Year's Day, Easter Monday, Labour Day, Victory in Europe Day, Ascension Day, Bastille Day, Assumption, All Saints' Day, Armistice Day, Christmas Day	Whit Monday is the solidarity day (worked).
Australia (NSW)	New Year's Day, Australia Day, Good Friday, Easter Saturday, Easter Sunday, Easter Monday, Anzac Day, King's Birthday, Labour Day, Christmas Day, Boxing Day	Substitute days only where gazetted.
United Kingdom (England and Wales)	New Year's Day, Good Friday, Easter Monday, Early May bank holiday, Spring bank holiday, Summer bank holiday, Christmas Day, Boxing Day	

Employees may use annual leave for religious or cultural days that are not public holidays. Managers approve such requests fairly and without asking for proof of belief. Where an

employee's religion requires time off for a day that is not on the calendar, HR considers a floating-day arrangement similar to the U.S. floating holidays.

Appendices

Appendix A – Approval Matrix (International)

This matrix adds to SIM-HR-001 Appendix E.

Decision	Initiates	Approves	Informed
New headcount in a non-U.S. center (budgeted)	Hiring manager	Country leader, Department Head, International HR Lead, Finance	Executive Team
New headcount in a country without an entity	Department Head	CEO, CFO, CPO, General Counsel	Board (at the next meeting)
Offer and compensation, non-U.S.	HR / hiring manager	Department Head and International HR Lead (Director and above: CPO)	Finance
Employment contract template changes	International HR Lead	CPO and General Counsel (local counsel review)	Country leader
Fixed-term contract or intern	Manager	International HR Lead	Country leader
Work from abroad up to 20 days	Employee	Manager and HR (Tax and IT Security informed)	Department Head
Work from abroad longer or permanent	Employee / manager	Department Head, HR, Legal, Tax, IT Security	CFO, CPO
Employer-of-record arrangement	Department Head	CPO, General Counsel, CFO	CEO
Transfer or secondment	Department Head	Chief People Officer and CFO (CEO for Executive Team)	Country leaders
Visa or work permit sponsorship	Department Head	International HR Lead and General Counsel	Finance

Appendix B – Work-from-Abroad and Cross-Border Request Checklist

Submit at least 30 days before the first day abroad.

#	Question	Answer
1	Employee, role, employing entity, manager	
2	Country and city of the temporary location	
3	Dates and number of working days (maximum 20 in a calendar year)	
4	Reason (personal, family, other)	
5	Right to enter and stay (citizen / visa); does the visa allow remote work?	
6	Will the employee deal with customers, sign contracts or negotiate in that country? (If yes: not allowed)	
7	Is the country on the sanctions or embargo list or a high-risk list? (If yes: not allowed)	
8	Which systems and data will be accessed? Any Restricted or export-controlled data?	
9	Network and device security arrangements (Company laptop, VPN, MFA)	
10	Days already used abroad this calendar year	
11	Manager approval and date	
12	HR approval and date	
13	Tax and IT Security informed (dates)	

Appendix C – International Onboarding Add-On Checklist

Use together with SIM-HR-001 Appendix B (replace the U.S. items 6–8 and 13 with the local equivalents).

#	Task	Owner	When
1	Right-to-work check completed under local law (and visa or permit verified where needed)	HR	Before start
2	Written contract or statement of terms issued in the required language and signed	HR	Before or on day 1
3	Tax number, social-insurance and pension registrations completed	HR / payroll provider	Before first pay run
4	Bank details and local payroll set-up	Employee / payroll	Week 1
5	Mandatory statutory information given (for example, Fair Work Information Statement in Australia)	HR	On or before day 1
6	Privacy notice and monitoring notice issued	HR	Day 1
7	Local Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement signed (with moral-rights consents where relevant)	Employee / HR	Day 1
8	Local health and safety induction, emergency numbers and first-aider introduction	Facilities / Site Lead	Day 1
9	Works council, CSE or union information given as the law requires	HR	As required
10	Introduction to shared windows and follow-the-sun handoffs	Manager	Week 1
11	Local benefits enrollment (health, pension, meal or transport benefits)	Employee / HR	By day 30
12	Required training completed in the employee's language	Employee	By day 30
13			

Appendix D – Glossary

Term	Meaning
A1 certificate	EU form showing which country's social security applies to a posted worker
Betriebsrat	German works council
CSE	<i>Comité social et économique</i> , the French employee representative body
Country HR Manual	HR manual for a non-U.S. location (SIM-HR-101 to SIM-HR-105)
EOR	Employer of record: a third party that legally employs a worker on a company's behalf in a country where the company has no entity
Follow-the-sun	Handing operations between time zones so work stays in daytime
GDPR / UK GDPR	European Union and United Kingdom data-protection regulations
International HR Lead	HR leader responsible for non-U.S. employees; reports to the Chief People Officer
Local counsel	Employment lawyers retained by the General Counsel in each jurisdiction
Secondment	Temporary posting of an employee to another entity or site while their home employment continues
Shared window	Agreed hours when team members in different time zones are all working
Works council	Elected body of employees with consultation or co-determination rights

Appendix E – Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change	Approved by
1.0	October 5, 2026	HR	Initial release of the Global People Supplement with the five Country HR Manuals	CEO (October 5, 2026)

End of document – SIM-HR-002